

Weekly Shopping Lists

Each list covers every recipe cooked that week for two people, including the batches that feed the following days and the freezer; leftovers are not listed twice. Cross off what is already in the cupboard. **Every week, as well:** two litres of milk or fortified soya milk for tea, coffee and the daily glass; a bag of unsalted mixed nuts; fruit for the daily piece (a dozen); a bag of ground flaxseed in the fridge; a spare tub of Greek yogurt. Amounts are rounded up to what you can actually buy; the leftover half of a can or a pepper goes into the next day's salad or soup.

Shopping List - Week 1 - Protein and Calcium, Every Meal

Beans, grains and cans

- ☐ brown rice: 280 g
- ☐ butter beans, drained and rinsed: 3 cans
- ☐ chopped tomatoes (400 g): 2 cans
- ☐ canned salmon, drained: 2 cans
- ☐ tuna in spring water, drained: 2 cans
- ☐ cannellini beans, drained and rinsed: 3 cans
- ☐ chickpeas (no added salt), drained and rinsed: 2 cans
- ☐ light coconut milk: 15 ml
- ☐ passata: 500 ml
- ☐ dried red lentils: 250 g
- ☐ reduced-salt vegetable stock: 1500 ml
- ☐ rolled oats: 160 g
- ☐ sardines in tomato sauce: 2 cans
- ☐ wholewheat couscous: 60 g
- ☐ wholewheat pasta: 300 g

Fish and meat

- ☐ skinless chicken breast: 1 breast
- ☐ skinless boneless chicken thighs: 4 thighs
- ☐ salmon fillet: 2 fillets
- ☐ lean turkey mince: 250 g

Dairy, eggs and chilled

- ☐ calcium-set tofu, firm: 1 block
- ☐ low-fat cottage cheese: 2 pots
- ☐ egg: 18
- ☐ greek yogurt, low-fat: 10 pots
- ☐ parmesan: 7 tbsp
- ☐ reduced-fat feta: 280 g
- ☐ semi-skimmed milk: 350 ml
- ☐ unsweetened soya milk: 300 ml

Bread

- ☐ oatcakes: 6 pieces
- ☐ wholemeal bread: 30 slices
- ☐ wholemeal pitta: 2 pieces

Nuts, seeds and oils

- ☐ almonds: 190 g
- ☐ cashews: 2 tbsp
- ☐ chia seeds: 4 tbsp
- ☐ ground almonds: 200 g
- ☐ ground flaxseed: 6 tsp
- ☐ hazelnuts: 2 tbsp
- ☐ olive oil: 250 ml
- ☐ pistachios: 3 tsp
- ☐ pumpkin seeds: 4 tbsp
- ☐ rapeseed oil: 27 ml
- ☐ sesame seeds: 2 tbsp
- ☐ walnuts: 2 tbsp

Fruit and vegetables

- ☐ apple: 2
- ☐ avocado: 1
- ☐ pepper: 1
- ☐ berries, fresh or frozen: 100 g
- ☐ blueberries: 150 g
- ☐ broccoli: 300 g
- ☐ carrot: 4
- ☐ cauliflower: 1
- ☐ cherry tomatoes: 18
- ☐ cucumber: 1
- ☐ frozen edamame beans: 240 g
- ☐ fresh herbs: 60 g
- ☐ garlic: 15 cloves
- ☐ ginger: 2 thumbs

- ☐ kale: 120 g
- ☐ lemon: 1
- ☐ lettuce or salad leaves: 1 bag
- ☐ mango: 160 g
- ☐ onion: 4
- ☐ orange: 1
- ☐ peach or nectarine: 2
- ☐ red onion: 2
- ☐ spinach: 3 bags
- ☐ spring onion: 10 pieces
- ☐ tomato: 6

Store cupboard

- ☐ baking powder: 2 tsp
- ☐ cinnamon: 2 tsp
- ☐ cod fillet: 2 fillets
- ☐ dried herbs or spices: 3 tbsp
- ☐ figs, fresh: 4
- ☐ honey: 100 g
- ☐ lemon juice: 140 g
- ☐ lime juice: 2 tbsp
- ☐ orange juice: 150 g
- ☐ reduced-salt soy sauce: 3 tbsp
- ☐ ricotta, part-skim: 300 g
- ☐ rocket: 2 bags
- ☐ sea salt: 1 tsp
- ☐ sugar: 100 g
- ☐ vanilla extract: 2 tsp
- ☐ watercress: 1 bag
- ☐ wholemeal flour: 60 g

Shopping List - Week 2 - The Menopause Plate

Beans, grains and cans

- ☐ black beans, drained and rinsed: 1 can
- ☐ brown rice: 520 g
- ☐ chopped tomatoes (400 g): 2 cans
- ☐ canned salmon, drained: 2 cans
- ☐ cannellini beans, drained and rinsed: 4 cans
- ☐ chickpeas (no added salt), drained and rinsed: 3 cans
- ☐ light coconut milk: 1 can
- ☐ kidney beans, drained and rinsed: 1 can
- ☐ quinoa: 140 g
- ☐ reduced-salt chicken stock: 650 ml
- ☐ reduced-salt vegetable stock: 1000 ml
- ☐ rice noodles: 120 g
- ☐ rolled oats: 270 g
- ☐ sardines, canned in oil, drained: 2 cans
- ☐ wholewheat pasta: 300 g

Fish and meat

- ☐ skinless chicken breast: 2 breasts
- ☐ skinless boneless chicken thighs: 6 thighs
- ☐ chicken, roast, skinless: 160 g
- ☐ lean pork loin steaks: 2 steaks
- ☐ prawns, cooked: 200 g

Dairy, eggs and chilled

- ☐ calcium-set tofu, firm: 2 blocks
- ☐ low-fat cottage cheese: 3 pots
- ☐ egg: 4
- ☐ greek yogurt, low-fat: 8 pots
- ☐ hummus: 60 g
- ☐ low-fat cream cheese: 60 g
- ☐ parmesan: 8 tbsp

- ☐ reduced-fat cheddar: 6 tbsp
- ☐ reduced-fat feta: 70 g
- ☐ semi-skimmed milk: 950 ml
- ☐ silken tofu: 1 block
- ☐ skimmed milk powder: 4 tbsp
- ☐ unsweetened soya milk: 1150 ml

Bread

- ☐ oatcakes: 10 pieces
- ☐ wholemeal bread: 18 slices

Nuts, seeds and oils

- ☐ almond butter: 2 tbsp
- ☐ almonds: 60 g
- ☐ chia seeds: 2 tbsp
- ☐ ground almonds: 4 tbsp
- ☐ ground flaxseed: 4 tbsp
- ☐ olive oil: 150 ml
- ☐ pistachios: 3 tsp
- ☐ pumpkin seeds: 4 tbsp
- ☐ rapeseed oil: 31 ml
- ☐ sesame seeds: 2 tbsp
- ☐ tahini: 120 g
- ☐ walnuts: 2 tbsp

Fruit and vegetables

- ☐ apple: 3
- ☐ banana: 2
- ☐ pepper: 2
- ☐ berries, fresh or frozen: 100 g
- ☐ broccoli: 300 g
- ☐ carrot: 7
- ☐ cherry tomatoes: 30
- ☐ cucumber: 2
- ☐ frozen edamame beans: 360 g

- ☐ fresh herbs: 11 tbsp
- ☐ garlic: 19 cloves
- ☐ ginger: 2 thumbs
- ☐ green beans: 160 g
- ☐ green cabbage or white cabbage: 180 g
- ☐ kale: 210 g
- ☐ leek: 3
- ☐ lemon: 2
- ☐ onion: 4
- ☐ peach or nectarine: 2
- ☐ potato: 3
- ☐ raspberries: 60 g
- ☐ spinach: 2 bags
- ☐ spring onion: 2 pieces

Store cupboard

- ☐ capers, drained: 3 tsp
- ☐ cinnamon: 1 tsp
- ☐ curry powder: 6 tsp
- ☐ dark chocolate (70%): 60 g
- ☐ dates: 4
- ☐ dried apricots: 8 pieces
- ☐ dried herbs or spices: 8 tsp
- ☐ fennel bulb: 1
- ☐ frozen peas: 120 g
- ☐ honey: 80 g
- ☐ kefir, low-fat: 500 ml
- ☐ lemon juice: 120 g
- ☐ lime juice: 2 tbsp
- ☐ maple syrup: 2 tbsp
- ☐ mustard: 1 tbsp
- ☐ reduced-salt soy sauce: 1 tbsp
- ☐ ricotta, part-skim: 100 g

- ☐ sea salt: 1 tsp
- ☐ tempeh: 1 block
- ☐ trout fillet: 2 fillets
- ☐ vanilla extract: 2 tsp
- ☐ vinegar: 2 tsp

Shopping List - Week 3 - Soya, Fish and the Freezer

Beans, grains and cans

- ☐ brown rice: 280 g
- ☐ chopped tomatoes (400 g): 3 cans
- ☐ canned salmon, drained: 1 can
- ☐ cannellini beans, drained and rinsed: 1 can
- ☐ chickpeas (no added salt), drained and rinsed: 1 can
- ☐ green lentils, drained and rinsed: 4 cans
- ☐ rice noodles: 120 g
- ☐ rolled oats: 280 g
- ☐ sardines, canned in oil, drained: 1 can
- ☐ sardines in tomato sauce: 2 cans
- ☐ tomato puree: 2 tbsp
- ☐ wholewheat pasta: 120 g

Fish and meat

- ☐ mackerel fillet: 2 fillets

Dairy, eggs and chilled

- ☐ calcium-set tofu, firm: 3 blocks
- ☐ low-fat cottage cheese: 4 pots
- ☐ egg: 13
- ☐ greek yogurt, low-fat: 10 pots
- ☐ parmesan: 8 tbsp
- ☐ reduced-fat cheddar: 6 tbsp
- ☐ reduced-fat feta: 200 g
- ☐ semi-skimmed milk: 300 ml
- ☐ skimmed milk powder: 4 tbsp
- ☐ unsweetened soya milk: 400 ml
- ☐ soya yogurt, unsweetened: 2 pots

Bread

- ☐ oatcakes: 10 pieces
- ☐ wholemeal bread: 12 slices

- ☐ wholemeal pitta: 2 pieces
- ☐ wholewheat tortilla: 2 pieces

Nuts, seeds and oils

- ☐ almond butter: 60 g
- ☐ almonds: 240 g
- ☐ chia seeds: 2 tbsp
- ☐ ground almonds: 4 tbsp
- ☐ ground flaxseed: 4 tbsp
- ☐ hazelnuts: 2 tbsp
- ☐ olive oil: 150 ml
- ☐ olives: 2 tbsp
- ☐ peanut butter (no added sugar or salt): 2 tbsp
- ☐ pumpkin seeds: 70 g
- ☐ rapeseed oil: 27 ml
- ☐ sesame seeds: 2 tbsp
- ☐ sunflower seeds: 3 tsp
- ☐ walnuts: 2 tbsp

Fruit and vegetables

- ☐ apple: 9
- ☐ aubergine: 2
- ☐ banana: 2
- ☐ cooked beetroot: 2
- ☐ pepper: 2
- ☐ berries, fresh or frozen: 100 g
- ☐ blackberries: 120 g
- ☐ blueberries: 150 g
- ☐ broccoli: 450 g
- ☐ carrot: 1
- ☐ cherry tomatoes: 6
- ☐ cucumber: 1
- ☐ fresh herbs: 14 tbsp
- ☐ garlic: 12 cloves

- ☐ ginger: 2 thumbs
- ☐ green beans: 160 g
- ☐ kale: 60 g
- ☐ lemon: 1
- ☐ lettuce or salad leaves: 1 bag
- ☐ mushrooms: 100 g
- ☐ onion: 3
- ☐ potato: 2
- ☐ spinach: 2 bags
- ☐ spring onion: 13 pieces
- ☐ sweet potato: 2
- ☐ tomato: 6

Store cupboard

- ☐ baking powder: 1 tsp
- ☐ capers, drained: 2 tbsp
- ☐ cinnamon: 2 tsp
- ☐ dark chocolate (70%): 4 tbsp
- ☐ dates: 8
- ☐ dried apricots: 8 pieces
- ☐ dried herbs or spices: 5 tsp
- ☐ honey: 90 g
- ☐ kefir, low-fat: 500 ml
- ☐ lemon juice: 80 g
- ☐ lime juice: 1 tbsp
- ☐ miso paste: 3 tbsp
- ☐ mustard: 1 tsp
- ☐ plain flour: 3 tbsp
- ☐ reduced-salt soy sauce: 3 tbsp
- ☐ ricotta, part-skim: 200 g
- ☐ rocket: 1 bag
- ☐ sea salt: 1 tsp
- ☐ sirloin steak, lean: 1 steak

- ☐ sugar: 3 tsp
- ☐ vanilla extract: 1 tsp
- ☐ wholemeal flour: 60 g

Shopping List - Week 4 - Make It Yours

Beans, grains and cans

- ☐ brown rice: 280 g
- ☐ canned salmon, drained: 3 cans
- ☐ tuna in spring water, drained: 2 cans
- ☐ cannellini beans, drained and rinsed: 2 cans
- ☐ chickpeas (no added salt), drained and rinsed: 2 cans
- ☐ light coconut milk: 15 ml
- ☐ quinoa: 140 g
- ☐ rice noodles: 120 g
- ☐ rolled oats: 240 g
- ☐ sardines, canned in oil, drained: 2 cans
- ☐ wholewheat couscous: 60 g
- ☐ wholewheat pasta: 150 g

Fish and meat

- ☐ skinless chicken breast: 3 breasts
- ☐ skinless boneless chicken thighs: 4 thighs
- ☐ chicken, roast, skinless: 160 g
- ☐ salmon fillet: 2 fillets

Dairy, eggs and chilled

- ☐ calcium-set tofu, firm: 2 blocks
- ☐ low-fat cottage cheese: 6 pots
- ☐ egg: 9
- ☐ greek yogurt, low-fat: 8 pots
- ☐ hummus: 60 g
- ☐ low-fat cream cheese: 60 g
- ☐ parmesan: 4 tbsp
- ☐ reduced-fat feta: 140 g
- ☐ semi-skimmed milk: 1150 ml
- ☐ unsweetened soya milk: 700 ml
- ☐ soya yogurt, unsweetened: 2 pots

Bread

- ☐ oatcakes: 6 pieces
- ☐ wholemeal bread: 22 slices
- ☐ wholemeal pitta: 2 pieces
- ☐ wholewheat tortilla: 2 pieces

Nuts, seeds and oils

- ☐ almonds: 4 tbsp
- ☐ cashews: 2 tbsp
- ☐ chia seeds: 70 g
- ☐ ground flaxseed: 4 tbsp
- ☐ olive oil: 150 ml
- ☐ peanuts: 2 tbsp
- ☐ pistachios: 3 tsp
- ☐ pumpkin seeds: 4 tbsp
- ☐ rapeseed oil: 40 ml
- ☐ sesame seeds: 3 tbsp
- ☐ tahini: 60 g
- ☐ walnuts: 2 tbsp

Fruit and vegetables

- ☐ apple: 2
- ☐ avocado: 1
- ☐ pepper: 4
- ☐ berries, fresh or frozen: 200 g
- ☐ broccoli: 300 g
- ☐ carrot: 3
- ☐ cauliflower: 1
- ☐ cherry tomatoes: 30
- ☐ cucumber: 2
- ☐ frozen edamame beans: 240 g
- ☐ fresh herbs: 14 tbsp
- ☐ garlic: 11 cloves
- ☐ ginger: 2 thumbs

- ☐ green cabbage or white cabbage: 180 g
- ☐ kale: 180 g
- ☐ lemon: 1
- ☐ lettuce or salad leaves: 1 bag
- ☐ mango: 160 g
- ☐ peach or nectarine: 4
- ☐ red onion: 2
- ☐ spinach: 2 bags
- ☐ spring onion: 12 pieces
- ☐ tomato: 2

Store cupboard

- ☐ capers, drained: 3 tsp
- ☐ cinnamon: 2 tsp
- ☐ dates: 4
- ☐ dried apricots: 8 pieces
- ☐ dried herbs or spices: 5 tsp
- ☐ figs, fresh: 4
- ☐ honey: 120 g
- ☐ lemon juice: 160 g
- ☐ lime juice: 3 tbsp
- ☐ mustard: 2 tsp
- ☐ orange juice: 150 g
- ☐ reduced-salt soy sauce: 80 g
- ☐ ricotta, part-skim: 100 g
- ☐ rocket: 2 bags
- ☐ sea salt: 1 tsp
- ☐ vanilla extract: 2 tsp
- ☐ vinegar: 2 tsp
- ☐ watercress: 1 bag

28-Day Meal Planner

Pin this to the fridge. Codes point to the recipe chapter; * means leftovers or a freezer portion. Tick each day when it is done.

Week 1 - Protein and Calcium, Every Meal

Day	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner	Snacks / dessert	Done
1	Yogurt, Flaxseed and Berry Bowl (B1)	Salmon and White Bean Salad with Lemon and Dill (L1)	Salmon with Sesame Greens and Brown Rice (D1)	Greek Yogurt with Almonds and Honey (S1); Baked Peaches with Ricotta and Pistachios (P2)	☐
2	Spinach, Feta and Tomato Omelette (B6)	Spinach and Lentil Soup with Yogurt (L6)	Turkey and Kale Meatballs in Tomato Sauce (D5)	Glass of milk	☐
3	Tofu and Spinach Scramble on Wholemeal Toast (B2)	Chickpea, Feta and Cucumber Pitta (L4)	Chicken and Broccoli Stir-Fry with Cashews (D2)	Cottage Cheese and Oatcakes with Tomato (S3); Poached Figs with Yogurt and Walnuts (P5)	☐
4	Bircher Muesli with Grated Apple and Yogurt (B10)	Spinach and Lentil Soup with Yogurt (L6*)	Greek Bean Stew with Feta (D11)	Greek Yogurt with Almonds and Honey (S1)	☐
5	Sardines on Toast with Tomato and Lemon (B4)	Tuna, Cannellini and Rocket Salad with Parmesan (L9)	Turkey and Kale Meatballs in Tomato Sauce (D5*)	Glass of milk; Handful of nuts; Chia Pudding with Mango and Coconut (P4)	☐
6	Ricotta Pancakes with Blueberries (B12)	Greek Bean Stew with Feta (D11*)	Cod with Chickpeas, Tomatoes and Spinach (D15)	Edamame with Sesame and Lemon (S2)	☐
7	Baked Eggs in Tomato with White Beans (B11)	Egg, Watercress and Avocado Open Sandwich (L8)	Chicken, Lemon and Yogurt Traybake with Cauliflower (D8)	Roasted Almonds and Pumpkin Seeds (S4); Almond and Orange Cake (P3)	☐

Week 2 - The Menopause Plate

Day	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner	Snacks / dessert	Done
8	Overnight Oats with Soya Milk, Chia and Apricots (B3)	Tofu, Edamame and Sesame Noodle Salad (L2)	Tofu and Chickpea Curry with Spinach (D3)	Greek Yogurt with Almonds and Honey (S1)	☐
9	Kefir, Banana and Almond Butter Smoothie (B7)	Broccoli and Almond Soup with Parmesan (L3)	Sardine and Tomato Spaghetti with Chilli (D6)	Glass of milk; Almond and Orange Cake (P3*)	☐
10	Cottage Cheese, Peach and Pumpkin Seed Bowl (B5)	Tofu, Edamame and Sesame Noodle Salad (L2*)	Tempeh and Black Bean Chilli (D9)	Hummus and Vegetable Sticks (S5)	☐
11	Porridge with Milk, Tahini and Dates (B8)	Tofu and Chickpea Curry with Spinach (D3*)	Baked Trout with Almonds and Green Beans (D4)	Cheese, Apple and Walnut Plate (S6); Chocolate Tofu Mousse (P1)	☐
12	Yogurt, Flaxseed and Berry Bowl (B1)	Broccoli and Almond Soup with Parmesan (L3*)	Pork Loin with Apple, Fennel and White Beans (D12)	Hummus and Vegetable Sticks (S5); <i>Glass of milk; Chocolate Tofu Mousse (P1)</i>	☐
13	Salmon, Cream Cheese and Cucumber on Rye (B9)	Chicken, Hummus and Slaw Sandwich (L12)	Prawn, Pea and Ricotta Pasta (D13)	Greek Yogurt with Almonds and Honey (S1)	☐
14	Spinach, Feta and Tomato Omelette (B6)	Chicken, Kale and Quinoa Bowl with Tahini Dressing (L7)	Chicken and White Bean Casserole with Kale (D17)	Edamame with Sesame and Lemon (S2); Rice Pudding with Soya Milk and Cardamom (P6)	☐

Week 3 - Soya, Fish and the Freezer

Day	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner	Snacks / dessert	Done
15	Tofu and Spinach Scramble on Wholemeal	Miso Tofu and Vegetable Soup (L10)	Tofu Steaks with Peanut Sauce and Greens (D14)	Glass of milk; Rice Pudding with Soya Milk and Cardamom	☐

	Toast (B2)			(P6*)	
16	Bircher Muesli with Grated Apple and Yogurt (B10)	Chicken and White Bean Casserole with Kale (D17*)	Salmon Fishcakes with Yogurt Tartare (D19)	Greek Yogurt with Almonds and Honey (S1)	☐
17	Overnight Oats with Soya Milk, Chia and Apricots (B3)	Miso Tofu and Vegetable Soup (L10*)	Aubergine, Lentil and Yogurt Bake (D20)	Cottage Cheese and Oatcakes with Tomato (S3); Dark Chocolate and Almond Dates (P7)	☐
18	Kefir, Banana and Almond Butter Smoothie (B7)	Sardine, Tomato and Olive Pasta Salad (L5)	Tempeh and Black Bean Chilli (D9*)	Glass of milk; Handful of nuts; Dark Chocolate and Almond Dates (P7*)	☐
19	Ricotta Pancakes with Blueberries (B12)	Cottage Cheese, Pepper and Herb Wrap (L11)	Mackerel with Beetroot, Yogurt and Rye (D10)	Soya Yogurt with Flaxseed and Berries (S8)	☐
20	Sardines on Toast with Tomato and Lemon (B4)	Aubergine, Lentil and Yogurt Bake (D20*)	Beef, Broccoli and Sesame Rice Bowl (D16)	Roasted Almonds and Pumpkin Seeds (S4); Glass of milk; Apple and Blackberry Crumble with Oat and Seed Topping (P8)	☐
21	Baked Eggs in Tomato with White Beans (B11)	Chickpea, Feta and Cucumber Pitta (L4)	Lentil, Sweet Potato and Spinach Bake with Feta (D7)	Cheese, Apple and Walnut Plate (S6); Apple and Blackberry Crumble with Oat and Seed Topping (P8*)	☐

Week 4 - Make It Yours

Day	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner	Snacks / dessert	Done
22	Yogurt, Flaxseed and Berry Bowl (B1)	Salmon and White Bean Salad with Lemon and Dill (L1)	Chicken and Broccoli Stir-Fry with Cashews (D2)	Greek Yogurt with Almonds and Honey (S1)	☐
23	Cottage Cheese,	Tuna, Cannellini	Lentil, Sweet	Glass of milk;	☐

	Peach and Pumpkin Seed Bowl (B5)	and Rocket Salad with Parmesan (L9)	Potato and Spinach Bake with Feta (D7*)	Handful of nuts; Baked Peaches with Ricotta and Pistachios (P2)	
24	Porridge with Milk, Tahini and Dates (B8)	Egg, Watercress and Avocado Open Sandwich (L8)	Vegetable and Tofu Noodles, Pad Thai Style (D18)	Edamame with Sesame and Lemon (S2)	☐
25	Spinach, Feta and Tomato Omelette (B6)	Chicken, Hummus and Slaw Sandwich (L12)	Eat out (Ch. 11)	Greek Yogurt with Almonds and Honey (S1)	☐
26	Overnight Oats with Soya Milk, Chia and Apricots (B3)	Chicken, Kale and Quinoa Bowl with Tahini Dressing (L7)	Salmon with Sesame Greens and Brown Rice (D1)	Golden Milk (S7); Poached Figs with Yogurt and Walnuts (P5)	☐
27	Salmon, Cream Cheese and Cucumber on Rye (B9)	Cottage Cheese, Pepper and Herb Wrap (L11)	Chicken, Lemon and Yogurt Traybake with Cauliflower (D8)	Soya Yogurt with Flaxseed and Berries (S8); Glass of milk; Chia Pudding with Mango and Coconut (P4)	☐
28	Tofu and Spinach Scramble on Wholemeal Toast (B2)	Chickpea, Feta and Cucumber Pitta (L4)	Sardine and Tomato Spaghetti with Chilli (D6)	Golden Milk (S7); Chia Pudding with Mango and Coconut (P4*)	☐

My Own Week

Write your own week from the recipes you liked. The rules: about 25 g of protein at each meal; calcium at every meal (dairy, fortified soya, tofu, canned fish with bones, greens, tahini); oily fish twice; soya twice; beans and greens most days; nuts daily; caffeine before noon; wine rarely. Write the protein and calcium beside each meal until you no longer need to.

Day	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner	Snacks / dessert	Protein / calcium	Done
Mon						☐
Tue						☐
Wed						☐
Thu						☐
Fri						☐
Sat						☐
Sun						☐

Day	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner	Snacks / dessert	Protein / calcium	Done
Mon						☐
Tue						☐
Wed						☐
Thu						☐
Fri						☐
Sat						☐
Sun						☐

Hot-Flush, Sleep and Numbers Tracker

Fill in the first week before you change anything, so that you have a baseline.

Flushes and sleep, day by day

Flushes: how many in the day and how many at night. Sleep: hours, and how many times you woke. Triggers: what you had in the two hours before a bad one (coffee, wine, spicy food, a hot drink, a hot room, stress).

Day	Flushes (day / night)	Hours slept	Times woken	Mood (1 to 5)	Possible triggers	Notes
Baseline Mon						
Tue						
Wed						
Thu						
Fri						
Sat						
Sun						
Week 1 Mon						
Tue						
Wed						
Thu						
Fri						
Sat						
Sun						

Week 2 Mon						
Tue						
Wed						
Thu						
Fri						
Sat						
Sun						
Week 3 Mon						
Tue						
Wed						
Thu						
Fri						
Sat						
Sun						
Week 4 Mon						
Tue						
Wed						
Thu						
Fri						
Sat						
Sun						

Your numbers

Date	Weight	Waist	Blood pressure	Total / LDL / HDL cholesterol	HbA1c or fasting glucose	Vitamin D	Bone scan (T-score, hip / spine)	Notes

The habits, week by week

Tick each day you managed all four: 25 g of protein at each meal; calcium at every meal; caffeine before noon only and wine rarely; the daily walk or the strength routine.

	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Week 1							
Week 2							
Week 3							
Week 4							
Week 5							
Week 6							
Week 7							

Week 8							
Week 9							
Week 10							
Week 11							
Week 12							

The Fridge Card: The Menopause Plate and the Calcium Counter

Cut out and keep on the fridge.

The plate: half vegetables and fruit; a quarter whole grain, beans or potato; a quarter protein (25 g: a palm of fish, chicken or tofu, two eggs and cottage cheese, a pot of Greek yogurt with nuts); dairy or fortified soya at every meal; olive oil as the fat; a handful of nuts a day.

About 300 mg of calcium is...	
A glass of milk (250 ml), or fortified soya, oat, almond or rice milk	300 mg
A pot of yogurt or skyr (150 to 170 g)	200 to 250 mg
A matchbox of hard cheese (30 g)	250 mg
A can of sardines with bones	350 mg; canned salmon 200 mg
Half a block of calcium-set tofu (150 g)	500 mg
2 tbsp tahini	130 mg; 1 tbsp sesame seeds 90 mg
3 tbsp ground almonds or a handful of almonds	80 mg
2 handfuls of kale or watercress, cooked	100 to 150 mg; spinach counts for less (oxalate)
A tin of white beans (drained)	100 mg
2 slices of wholemeal bread	80 mg (more if calcium-fortified flour, as in the UK)
2 tbsp skimmed milk powder in anything	200 mg

The target: 1,200 mg a day from food for women over 50, plus vitamin D (10 micrograms / 400 IU a day, more if your doctor says), and a bone scan if you are over 65 or have a risk factor.

Protein: 1.0 to 1.2 g per kilo a day (65 to 80 g for 65 kg), as 25 g at each meal. **Oily fish** twice a week. **Soya** most days if you like it. **Flaxseed** a spoon a day. **Alcohol and caffeine after noon:** the two most common flush and sleep triggers; test them one at a time.

From The Menopause Diet Plan for Women Over 50 by Eleanor Whitfield.
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